

21-Day Study Plan — AI-Assisted Development Interview Prep

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A day-by-day schedule to internalize all 6 chapters, drill the 18-question catalog, and walk into any AI-context interview ready to perform.

Use the in-app drill at `/interview-drill` for randomized question practice and `/study` to track lesson completion. Both persist in your browser via local-Storage.

Week 1 — The Conceptual Foundation (Days 1-7)

Goal by Sunday: confident on the modern engineer's role; can deliver the 90-second self-intro and the seven-pillar answer cold.

Day 1 (60 min) — Orientation

- Read `ai-interview-course/README.md` end to end.
- Skim every chapter README to see the arc.
- Open the live deployed React Snooker app — that's your portfolio example throughout this course.
- *Output*: list the 3 questions you most want to answer well by Day 21.

Day 2 (60 min) — Chapter 1.1

- Read `chapter-01-foundations/01-what-changed.md`.
- Memorize the **5 generations of AI tooling** and the **3 workflows**.

- Practice the 30-second self-intro out loud, twice.
- *Output*: write down your real-life “AI generation” — which one are you actually on?

Day 3 (60 min) — Chapter 1.2 + 1.3

- Read 02-the-skill-stack.md and 03-the-mindset-shift.md.
- Identify the 5 layers of engineering work and which you’re strongest / weakest at.
- *Output*: 1 example from your own work for each of the 5 layers.

Day 4 (75 min) — Chapter 2.1 (The Big Question, part 1)

- Read chapter-02-the-big-question/01-the-five-framings.md.
- For each framing, practice the opening 15 seconds of your response.
- *Output*: pick the framing you find hardest and write a full answer to it.

Day 5 (90 min) — Chapter 2.2 (THE centerpiece)

- Read 02-the-seven-pillars.md.
- Memorize all 7 pillars by name.
- Practice the 90-second master answer 3 times, looking up only as needed.
- *Output*: deliver the master answer end-to-end without notes; record it.

Day 6 (75 min) — Chapter 2.3

- Read 03-real-world-cases.md.
- Fill in the STAR worksheet at the bottom with 2-3 of your own real cases.
- Practice telling one case story in 60 seconds.
- *Output*: 3 STAR stories in your notes file.

Day 7 (60 min) — Week 1 review

- Re-read cheat-sheets/ai-ch01.md and cheat-sheets/ai-ch02.md.
- 30-minute flashcard session: tags self-quiz and concept, source chapter 1-2.
- Practice 5 random questions in /interview-drill.
- *Output*: weekly retro paragraph.

Week 2 — Craft and Live Skill (Days 8-14)

Goal by Sunday: prompt mastery solid, can walk into a live pair-programming round and run the 60-second playbook.

Day 8 (60 min) — Chapter 3.1

- Read `chapter-03-prompt-mastery/01-anatomy-of-a-prompt.md`.
- Pull out 3 real prompts from your last week of work; analyze each on the 6 components.
- *Output*: rewrite one of them using all 6 components.

Day 9 (60 min) — Chapter 3.2

- Read `02-the-twelve-patterns.md`.
- Pick the 4 patterns most relevant to your daily work; memorize their names.
- *Output*: deploy each of the 4 patterns once today in your actual editor.

Day 10 (60 min) — Chapter 3.3

- Read `03-rejecting-ai-output.md`.
- Start a `REJECTION_JOURNAL.md` in your private notes; commit to logging 1 rejection/day for the next week.
- *Output*: today's first rejection journal entry.

Day 11 (75 min) — Chapter 4.1

- Read `chapter-04-live-scenarios/01-live-pair-programming.md`.
- Memorize the 60-second playbook (the 4 spoken opening lines).
- Practice the playbook out loud on a fake prompt ("build a function that...").
- *Output*: deliver the playbook from memory.

Day 12 (75 min) — Chapter 4.2

- Read `02-debugging-ai-bugs.md`.
- Memorize the 4-step diagnosis flowchart and the 7 failure signatures.
- *Output*: write down 1 real bug you've debugged that matches one of the signatures.

Day 13 (60 min) – Chapter 4.3

- Read 03-code-review-of-ai.md.
- Memorize the 11-item review checklist.
- Apply it to a real PR or a recent diff from your work.
- *Output*: list of 3 things the checklist would have caught.

Day 14 (60 min) – Week 2 review

- Re-read cheat-sheets/ai-ch03.md and cheat-sheets/ai-ch04.md.
 - 30-minute flashcard session: chapters 3-4.
 - Practice 10 random questions in /interview-drill.
 - *Output*: weekly retro.
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Week 3 – Architecture, Culture, Closing (Days 15-21)

Goal by Sunday: full 18-question catalog at your fingertips, 90-second portfolio narrative locked, 3 closing questions ready.

Day 15 (60 min) – Chapter 5.1

- Read chapter-05-system-design/01-what-humans-still-own.md.
- Memorize the 6 categories of architecture decision.
- *Output*: 1 personal example for each category.

Day 16 (90 min) – Chapter 5.2

- Read 02-design-with-ai-walkthrough.md.
- Walk through the 60-minute design hour out loud, on paper, on your own.
- *Output*: your own version of the architecture sketch.

Day 17 (60 min) – Chapter 5.3

- Read 03-trade-off-conversations.md.
- Memorize the 5-step trade-off structure and the 8 axes.
- Pick 3 of the 12 rapid-drill trade-offs; deliver each in 60 seconds.

- *Output:* 3 recorded 60-second trade-off answers.

Day 18 (75 min) — Chapter 6.1

- Read `chapter-06-behavioral-and-closing/01-risks-and-accountability.md`.
- Memorize the 5 risks and the “Mine.” accountability answer.
- Write your 1-sentence personal commitment statement.
- *Output:* personal commitment statement on a sticky note.

Day 19 (60 min) — Chapter 6.2

- Read `02-team-dynamics.md`.
- Memorize the 7 cultural questions.
- Practice the “AI raises the floor; it doesn’t lower the ceiling” line until it sounds natural.
- *Output:* a 60-second answer to “how would you onboard a junior?”

Day 20 (90 min) — Chapter 6.3 (the closing)

- Read `03-portfolio-narrative.md`.
- Write your 90-second portfolio narrative based on the React Snooker project.
- Write your 3 closing questions to ask the interviewer.
- Write your 30/60/90-day promise.
- *Output:* all three in your notes, fully drafted.

Day 21 (90 min) — Capstone

- Run through the **18-question catalog** (`chapter-06-behavioral-and-closing/03-portfolio-narrative.md`).
 - For each, deliver a clean answer in 60-90 seconds.
 - Do a full mock-interview session in `/interview-drill` — 10 random questions, timed.
 - *Output:* a self-graded scorecard, plus a sticky note of the 3 questions you most need to keep drilling.
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Daily habits (every day, ~15 min on top)

- 10-minute flashcard review (flashcards/ai-interview.csv loaded in Anki).
- 5 minutes in /interview-drill doing 2 random questions.
- Listen to that day's audio narration MP3 (audio/ai-interview-course/...) while walking.
- 1 rejection journal entry.

The “interview tomorrow” condensed plan

If you have a real interview within 48 hours:

1. **Day -2 evening:** read 01-foundations/01-what-changed.md + 02-the-big-question/02-the-seven-pillars.md + 06-behavioral-and-closing/03-portfolio-narrative.md.
2. **Day -1 morning:** deliver the 90-second narrative and the seven-pillar answer 3x each.
3. **Day -1 afternoon:** 10-question drill in /interview-drill.
4. **Day -1 evening:** re-read all 6 cheat sheets back to back (cheat-sheets/ai-*.md).
5. **Day of:** re-read the “Mine.” accountability answer once. Coffee. Camera/mic check. One deep breath.

When you finish

Re-take the AI course in 3 months. The field will have moved. So will you.